

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Carpentry & Remodeling English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Carpenters, remodelers, finish carpenters, joinery installers, and carpentry crew leads.

Original fictional language practice, not carpentry instruction, structural assessment, legal advice, or a statement of code or permit requirements. All dimensions, incidents, quotations, products, and schedules in exercises are invented. Structural decisions, hazardous materials, tool use, installation methods, and site safety require qualified people and project-specific procedures. Sources establish occupational context, not endorsement of these cases.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Confirming openings and measurement references

Distinguish a client's usable-space requirement from a drawing dimension.

02 Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

Compare two finish choices without treating one feature as an overall verdict.

03 Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

Request a specific clarification with references, location, and consequence.

04 Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

Report a concealed-condition concern without diagnosing damage or minimizing it.

05 Separating requested extras from agreed work

Discuss an extra without silently adding it to the existing price.

06 Coordinating access and other trades

Distinguish a confirmed delivery from an available work area.

07 Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging

Repair an overstatement while agreeing a precise finish-review description.

08 Handing over records and return visits

Give the owner usable records and an identifiable follow-up contact.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Confirming openings and measurement references

Distinguish a client's usable-space requirement from a drawing dimension.

CASE

The hall drawing labels a door opening 900 millimeters. The client assumes this is clear passage width. The note does not say rough or finished opening; no door has been ordered. The designer can clarify the reference.

Teach this move

An opening dimension needs units and reference surfaces. Rough opening, finished opening, door-leaf width, and usable clear passage are different quantities. Even a finished opening measurement may not establish passage with the door and hardware present. Ask which requirement matters before discussing an order size.

Vocabulary to check: rough opening, finished opening, jamb, datum.

Model response

The drawing gives 900 millimeters, but it does not identify the measurement surfaces. Do you need that as the clear passage width, or were you referring to the framed opening? I will ask the designer to confirm the datum and jamb allowance before we treat this dimension as an order size.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision preserves the number while avoiding an unsupported promise about usable space.

Second-round challenge

The designer confirms a rough opening, but the client still asks whether a large cabinet will fit. Separate the two measurements.

Language-check answers

1. A - usable clear passage Correct. This is the unobstructed space available with the door in its relevant position.
2. D - which reference line it is Correct. The embedded question uses subject before verb: it is.

05 • Conversations

1. Nine hundred between which faces? - At the hall doorway, the carpenter and client clarify the fictional 900-millimeter note.
2. The floor that is not finished yet - A carpenter checks a cabinet-height reference with the site coordinator.
3. A width without its units - A carpenter and supplier resolve an ambiguous shelf enquiry by telephone.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 • Say it: second scenario | The alcove narrows at the back

An alcove survey records front width 1,210 millimeters and rear width 1,190 millimeters. A client calls it a 1,200-millimeter opening. No shelf fabrication size is approved.

Role A: Carpenter: distinguish the two measured locations from the shorthand description.

Role B: Client: you want full-depth shelves and can show the survey sketch.

Possible opening: Is twelve hundred the front measurement, the back measurement, or a rounded description?

Success checks

- Name both locations and dimensions aloud.
- Explain why an average is not a confirmed fabrication size.
- Agree who will clarify the shelf detail before ordering.

Add a complication: The client says a single average would be simpler for the order.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

Compare two finish choices without treating one feature as an overall verdict.

CASE

For a fictional study remodel, sample A is solid oak trim with pronounced grain and a ten-day quoted lead time. Sample B is oak-veneered trim with a more uniform appearance and a four-day quoted lead time. Both match the requested profile. No sample is selected.

Teach this move

A profile is shape; grain and sheen describe different aspects of appearance. Use the same criteria for both samples. A quoted lead time is supplier information, not a promise about the entire remodeling schedule.

Vocabulary to check: grain, veneer, profile, finish sample.

Model response

Both samples match the requested profile. Sample A has more pronounced grain and a quoted ten-day lead time, whereas sample B looks more uniform and is quoted at four days. Those are appearance and supply differences, not a general quality ranking. Which appearance would you like us to use as the reference?

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised comparison names a tradeoff instead of declaring a universal winner.

Second-round challenge

The supplier revises A's lead time to twelve days. Recompare the options without changing the client's appearance preference.

Language-check answers

1. D - profile Correct. Profile identifies the cross-sectional shape of the molding.
2. C - whereas Correct. 'Whereas' introduces a contrast.

05 · Conversations

1. Choosing the study trim reference - At a sample review, a carpenter and client compare the two study trim options.
2. White is not a complete finish description - A carpenter and decorator compare a trim sample with an existing painted surface.
3. The molding is wide enough but different - A carpenter questions a supplier's proposed replacement molding.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | One sample, two directions

A client approves the color of a veneered cabinet sample but says nothing about grain direction. The elevation shows horizontal grain; the sample was displayed vertically.

Role A: Carpenter: clarify whether approval covers color, direction, or both.

Role B: Client: you like the color but prefer vertical grain and have not discussed a revised elevation.

Possible opening: Does your approval cover the color only, or also the grain direction shown here?

Success checks

- Separate sample approval from drawing revision.
- State the preferred direction in ordinary words.
- Keep production confirmation pending the reconciled elevation.

Add a complication: The client assumes turning the sample also changes the production drawing.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

Request a specific clarification with references, location, and consequence.

CASE

Cabinet elevation C4 revision B shows a 20-millimeter reveal. Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters at the same end panel. Fabrication release is due for review at 14:00. The designer has not clarified which dimension applies.

Teach this move

A useful query lets the designer find the conflict without guessing. Name both documents and their revisions, describe the same physical location, and ask for the intended relationship. A review deadline is not permission to choose a dimension.

Vocabulary to check: elevation, section detail, scribe allowance, reveal.

Model response

Could you clarify the end-panel reveal before our 14:00 fabrication review? Elevation C4 revision B shows 20 millimeters, while section S2 revision B shows 15 at the same location. Please identify the intended dimension and the drawing that needs correction. We will keep this panel out of fabrication release until the conflict is resolved.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised statement locates the disagreement and avoids criticizing the whole drawing set.

Second-round challenge

You can answer only at 15:00. Agree how the panel's release status will be described at the 14:00 review.

Language-check answers

1. C - both drawings Correct. 'Both drawings show' confirms the two matching revision labels.
2. B - reveal Correct. Reveal names the intentionally visible strip or setback at this junction.

05 • Conversations

1. Two dimensions on revision B - A carpenter calls the designer before the cabinet fabrication review.

2. Extra width is not an extra shelf - A carpenter explains a supplier's scribe allowance note to a client.

3. A cloud on the drawing - A carpenter and site coordinator identify the actual extent of a revised drawing.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The detail says typical

A drawing labels a 10-millimeter reveal typical. A separate pantry elevation shows a 6-millimeter reveal. Both are current; neither names an exception.

Role A: Carpenter: ask whether the pantry is an exception.

Role B: Designer: you can review the pantry relationship but cannot answer from memory.

Possible opening: Does the typical reveal apply at the pantry, or is that elevation a deliberate exception?

Success checks

- Cite both details.
- Explain that typical does not resolve a stated conflict.
- Agree the pantry item remains pending clarification.

Add a complication: The site manager wants the carpenter to choose the larger dimension for consistency.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

Report a concealed-condition concern without diagnosing damage or minimizing it.

CASE

An existing exposed subfloor has dark staining beside the laundry doorway. The client asks whether the joists are rotten. The carpenter has not assessed structural condition and the joists are not visible. The project lead can arrange a qualified assessment.

Teach this move

Location, visibility, and source matter. A stain is an observation; decay and structural adequacy are conclusions requiring appropriate assessment. Keep urgent site concerns within the project's safety arrangements rather than treating this exercise as an inspection procedure.

Vocabulary to check: subfloor, joist, blocking, concealed condition.

Model response

The dark staining is visible on the subfloor beside the laundry doorway. It does not tell me the condition of the joists underneath, which are not visible. I cannot confirm decay or its cause from this observation. I will ask the project lead to arrange an assessment before we discuss any resulting scope change.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision avoids turning surface appearance into a structural conclusion.

Second-round challenge

The client remembers an old spill. Attribute that recollection without treating it as the confirmed explanation.

Language-check answers

1. B - concealed Correct. Concealed means the joists are hidden from this view.
2. A - does not establish Correct. Appearance alone does not identify cause.

05 • Conversations

1. A stain is not a joist assessment - At the laundry doorway, a carpenter answers the client's question about staining.
2. The photograph does not show the support - A carpenter and project lead discuss an incomplete site photograph.
3. A small gap with no agreed tolerance - A carpenter discusses a reported trim gap with the client's representative.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 • Say it: second scenario | A ceiling mark reported after delivery

A homeowner notices a ceiling mark above the hallway-to-study doorway after cabinet delivery through that doorway. No before-photo covers the area. The route is known, but the cause of the mark is not.

Role A: Carpenter: acknowledge the concern and distinguish timing from established cause.

Role B: Homeowner: you noticed the mark at 16:00 and want it reviewed.

Possible opening: I understand why the timing concerns you; can we identify exactly where the mark is?

Success checks

- Acknowledge the concern without blaming anyone.
- State the observation time and missing evidence.
- Agree who will review the mark and report back.

Add a complication: The homeowner asks you to confirm that the delivery crew caused it.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Separating requested extras from agreed work

Discuss an extra without silently adding it to the existing price.

CASE

The agreed bedroom scope includes replacing skirting only. The client requests a built-in bench; decorating is excluded. The carpenter can arrange a separate quotation, but no bench dimensions, price, or completion date are agreed.

Teach this move

Name the agreed work, the requested addition, and the unanswered cost or timing questions. An allowance is not automatic approval. A request for a quotation does not authorize construction. Skirting is commonly called baseboard in U.S. usage; making good means repairing or restoring disturbed finishes.

Vocabulary to check: change order, allowance, exclusion, making good.

Model response

The current bedroom scope covers skirting replacement and excludes decorating. A built-in bench would be an addition. We can keep the present scope or obtain a separate quotation for the bench, including any making good. If you want that comparison, we first need your intended size; its price and timing remain open.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised offer promises an assessment rather than unpriced work.

Second-round challenge

The client adds matching wall paneling. Identify it as another item to assess, not an assumed part of the bench.

Language-check answers

1. A - exclusion Correct. An exclusion identifies omitted work.
2. D - confirm Correct. Present simple introduces this future condition.

05 • Conversations

1. The bench is an addition - A carpenter and bedroom client discuss the requested bench.

2. Painting around the new frame - A carpenter and homeowner clarify restoration around a replacement frame.
3. A verbal suggestion becomes a request - A carpenter checks a shelving conversation with a tenant representative.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Who supplies the handles?

A wardrobe quotation includes fitting handles but excludes their supply. The client has selected handles online but has not ordered them. The supplier's delivery date is unknown.

Role A: Carpenter: explain supply versus fitting and ask who will arrange delivery.

Role B: Client: you assumed the carpenter would buy the selected handles.

Possible opening: The quote includes fitting the handles; can we confirm who is supplying them?

Success checks

- Distinguish supply from fitting.
- Agree who will check the selected product and delivery.
- Keep completion timing conditional on confirmed information.

Add a complication: The client wants the original completion date confirmed before supplier availability is checked.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Coordinating access and other trades

Distinguish a confirmed delivery from an available work area.

CASE

The joinery delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning. The decorator has not released the study for carpentry access. The hallway is available for a separate trim review at 11:00, but not for material storage. The site coordinator needs the current status.

Teach this move

Several schedules can be true at once and still conflict. State the material status, room access status, and resulting dependency separately. Do not use a clear corridor as an assumed storage or work area.

Vocabulary to check: lookahead schedule, trade interface, access window, protection plan.

Model response

Tuesday morning's joinery delivery is confirmed, but study access is still awaiting the decorator's release. The hallway is available for the 11:00 trim review only, not storage. Please confirm the study access window before we sequence the fitting work. I will ask the supplier about delivery flexibility while that dependency remains open.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The update identifies the condition that still prevents a reliable fitting sequence.

Second-round challenge

The decorator releases the study for Wednesday morning. Discuss what still needs checking with the supplier.

Language-check answers

1. D - on Correct. 'Depends on' identifies the condition.
2. C - the trim review Correct. Only the 11:00 trim review is agreed.

05 • Conversations

1. Delivery is ready, the room is not - A carpenter updates the site coordinator about Tuesday's joinery.
2. The countertop appointment moves - A carpenter and kitchen coordinator discuss a revised supplier visit.

3. The retained floor needs a clear boundary - A carpenter and homeowner discuss access through an occupied room.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The lift booking belongs to another crew

A cabinet delivery is proposed for 10:00. The service lift is booked for another trade from 09:30 to 11:00. The building manager can offer 11:30, subject to supplier agreement.

Role A: Carpenter: explain the conflict and propose checking the later slot.

Role B: Building manager: keep the existing booking and offer 11:30 for confirmation.

Possible opening: Our proposed delivery overlaps the booked lift window; is eleven thirty available for us?

Success checks

- Name the conflicting windows.
- Avoid claiming the later slot is final before both sides agree.
- Confirm the delivery and lift booking together.

Add a complication: The supplier can deliver at 11:30 but cannot provide storage before then.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging

Repair an overstatement while agreeing a precise finish-review description.

CASE

At a wardrobe review you said all fronts were flush. The client points to drawer D3, whose left edge projects beyond the neighboring front. You have not assessed the cause or remedy. Correct your earlier statement and add the specific observation for follow-up.

Teach this move

Use location and relationship rather than a vague judgment such as bad. Acknowledge an inaccurate statement directly. Recording a snag does not by itself identify its cause, the remedy, or the contractual outcome. Snag list and punch list name the same type of follow-up list here.

Vocabulary to check: flush, plumb, snag list, acceptance sample.

Model response

My earlier statement that all the fronts were flush was too broad. At drawer D3, the left edge projects beyond the neighboring front. I will add that observation to the snag list and ask the joinery lead to review it. We have identified the appearance issue, but have not yet agreed its cause or remedy.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The correction addresses the observation instead of dismissing the client's view.

Second-round challenge

The joinery lead cannot attend until Thursday. Agree the review appointment without promising a same-day remedy.

Language-check answers

1. C - flush Correct. Flush describes adjoining faces aligned in the same plane.
2. B - was Correct. The singular subject 'statement' takes 'was'.

05 · Conversations

1. I overlooked drawer D3 - A carpenter repairs an inaccurate statement during a wardrobe review.
2. Level and plumb are different questions - A carpenter and client discuss wording in a finish-review note.
3. The agreed sample covers sheen - A carpenter and owner compare a finished panel with an acceptance sample.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | An item is done but not checked

A snag list, also called a punch list, has five trim items. Items 1 and 2, the hall baseboard and study casing, are completed and reviewed. Items 3 and 4, the pantry return and window joint, are reported complete but not client-reviewed. Item 5, the store-door molding, awaits replacement.

Role A: Carpenter: separate completed work, reviewed items, and the pending replacement.

Role B: Client: you can review items 3 and 4, the pantry return and window joint, at 15:00.

Possible opening: Four items are reported complete, but you have reviewed only two so far.

Success checks

- Give the three different statuses.
- Confirm which two items will be reviewed at 15:00.
- Keep the replacement item open.

Add a complication: The client suggests marking all five closed before the afternoon visit.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Handing over records and return visits

Give the owner usable records and an identifiable follow-up contact.

CASE

The owner receives cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet. A replacement shelf pin cover is due but not delivered. The joinery lead, Mina, accepts supplier follow-up and will call Friday. The return-visit date is not confirmed; warranty terms remain those in the supplied document.

Teach this move

A handover is more useful when each document matches the supplied product and each outstanding item has an owner. A promised update date is not necessarily a delivery or return-visit date. Do not paraphrase warranty terms as guaranteed coverage.

Vocabulary to check: as-built record, care sheet, warranty document, return visit.

Model response

Here are the cabinet drawings and the care sheet for the finish actually supplied. The shelf pin cover is still outstanding. Mina has accepted supplier follow-up and will call you Friday with its status; the return-visit date is not yet confirmed. Please keep the supplied warranty document for its specific terms rather than relying on a general verbal promise.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision separates an update commitment from an unconfirmed attendance.

Second-round challenge

The supplier changes the expected delivery. Explain the revised status without interpreting warranty coverage.

Language-check answers

1. B - update Correct. Mina has agreed to call with status.
2. A - for Correct. 'For' links the sheet to its intended product.

05 • Conversations

1. Friday is the call, not the visit - A carpenter hands over cabinet documents to the owner.

2. The manual belongs to the old hardware - A carpenter and client identify a mismatched handover leaflet.

3. A callback needs a specific description - A carpenter clarifies a client's request for a return visit.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The named contact is away

The owner expects a Friday update about replacement drawer front D6. Its delivery date is unconfirmed. Mina is away; colleague Joel can accept supplier follow-up but has not yet spoken to the supplier.

Role A: Outgoing carpenter: ask Joel to accept the follow-up and distinguish known status from an expected reply.

Role B: Joel: you can contact the supplier today and call the owner Friday regardless of whether a date is confirmed.

Possible opening: Can you take over the drawer-front follow-up while Mina is away?

Success checks

- Confirm Joel accepts the task.
- Preserve the unknown delivery status.
- Keep Friday as an update, not a delivery promise.

Add a complication: The owner asks whether the change of contact means the part has arrived.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

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Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Carpenters

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/construction-and-extraction/carpenters.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Carpenters (47-2031.00), U.S. Department of Labor-sponsored occupational profile

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/47-2031.00>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Guided message practice gives four choices with explained feedback. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Adapt a partner or class activity

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Carpentry & Remodeling English

Professional audience: Carpenters, remodelers, finish carpenters, joinery installers, and carpentry crew leads

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Lesson 01: Confirming openings and measurement references

Original fictional case: The hall drawing labels a door opening 900 millimeters. The client assumes this is clear passage width. The note does not say rough or finished opening; no door has been ordered. The designer can clarify the reference.

Language workshop: Ask what the dimension describes

Communication goal: Distinguish a client's usable-space requirement from a drawing dimension.

Language guidance: An opening dimension needs units and reference surfaces. Rough opening, finished opening, door-leaf width, and usable clear passage are different quantities. Even a finished opening measurement may not establish passage with the door and hardware present. Ask which requirement matters before discussing an order size.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): Is ___ measured between ___ or ___? / When you say clear width, do you mean ___? / We have the dimension, but still need ___.

Vocabulary: rough opening: The framed space intended to receive a door or window unit before surrounding finishes are complete. / finished opening: The opening measured between specified completed surrounding surfaces; this is not automatically the usable clear passage with a door installed and open. /

jamb: A side or top member of a door or window frame. / datum: An agreed reference point or line from which project dimensions are measured.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the client. You need the usable passage clarified and have not chosen a door unit.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: The designer confirms a rough opening, but the client still asks whether a large cabinet will fit. Separate the two measurements.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: The drawing gives 900 millimeters, but it does not identify the measurement surfaces. Do you need that as the clear passage width, or were you referring to the framed opening? I will ask the designer to confirm the datum and jamb allowance before we treat this dimension as an order size.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Adapt a supported occupational language lesson

1. Ask for learner support needs, group size and time. Offer two B2 learners and 20 minutes as a default and wait for confirmation.
2. Use the reference's real language goal, terms and case facts. Provide a timed plan containing reading, four-choice dialogue gaps, scaffolded speaking, focused feedback and a retry. No activity may require open-ended writing.
3. Give two separate speaking role cards with known facts, an objective, a possible opening, one question to resolve and three success checks. Put model responses in a separate teacher section. Label invented complications and preserve uncertainty.
4. Include four original gap-fill exchanges with four plausible options each and exactly one answer. Provide option-specific explanations separately. B1 support adds a word bank and frames; C1 stretch uses more nuanced choices and spoken follow-up, not essays. Include solo rehearsal of both roles.
5. Check facts, terminology, answer uniqueness and timing before presenting the plan. Finish with a four-choice exit question and an optional spoken retry. Do not certify proficiency or teach professional procedures.

END PROMPT

Adjust tone and register

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Carpentry & Remodeling English

Professional audience: Carpenters, remodelers, finish carpenters, joinery installers, and carpentry crew leads

Scope: Original fictional language practice, not carpentry instruction, structural assessment, legal advice, or a statement of code or permit requirements. All dimensions, incidents, quotations, products, and schedules in exercises are invented. Structural decisions, hazardous materials, tool use, installation methods, and site safety require qualified people and project-specific procedures. Sources establish occupational context, not endorsement of these cases.

Lesson 01: Confirming openings and measurement references

Original fictional case: The hall drawing labels a door opening 900 millimeters. The client assumes this is clear passage width. The note does not say rough or finished opening; no door has been ordered. The designer can clarify the reference.

Language workshop: Ask what the dimension describes

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END REFERENCE

TASK: Match the wording to the listener

1. Quote one actual utterance from the reference. Identify its purpose, audience and degree of certainty. Offer a colleague, supervisor or outside customer as the new listener. Wait for my selection.
2. Supply four possible versions A-D and a specific constraint, such as explaining an unfamiliar abbreviation without changing a pending decision into approval. Make exactly one version satisfy all constraints. Wait for my choice.
3. Explain the strengths and limitations of every option. Treat valid stylistic alternatives as alternatives, not mistakes; rewrite an ambiguous question instead of rejecting reasonable English. Avoid national stereotypes.
4. Continue with three short, role-labelled exchanges in which I select the missing reply from four choices. Include a clarification and a disagreement. Wait after each item and invite a spoken rehearsal after feedback.
5. Finish with two complete model exchanges for different listeners. Identify what changed and what stayed the same. Do not assign open-ended writing.

END PROMPT